METROPOLITAN GRAND LODGE of LONDON

METROPOLITAN GRAND CHAPTER of LONDON

MENTOR'S HANDBOOK

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London

Metropolitan Grand Chapter

Metropolitan Grand Lodge/

MENTOR'S HANDBOOK

1 FOREWORD

If you have been appointed to the office of Mentor in your lodge or chapter, I would first like to congratulate you on your appointment to what, in my view, is the most important office in any unit. While a lodge or chapter is dependent on its regular progressive officers, the role of other officers is critical. It is your role, as Mentor, to coordinate planned and structured mentoring to nurture these members, new and old, so that their interest and enthusiasm for Freemasonry is both maintained and encouraged, thus enabling them to enjoy their Freemasonry to the extent that they not only want to stay and participate in all your activities, but that they also want to introduce their friends into your lodge or chapter.

As the official Mentor, you are not alone! There are many resources available to you to help you with your duties in that role. Foremost amongst these are the Mentoring Webinars, which are available online and can be undertaken from home or office. This handbook was designed, not to replace, but to complement the training and advice that you will have received by attending a webinar.

In the MetGL/GC Mentoring Team, we have thirty-nine experienced Mentors who are at your disposal to assist you with any questions or problems which you might encounter whilst performing your duties as Mentor. Every lodge and chapter in London have a Mentoring Liaison Officer (MLO) allocated. You can easily find your MLO's email address on the Mentoring section of Rosetta which shows both the full team, and which MLO works with which Inspector.

May I wish you every success in your mentoring and more importantly thank you for taking this big step in ensuring the continued growth and success of London Freemasonry.

With kind fraternal regards



Carl Lillington
Metropolitan Grand Mentor

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2 METROPOLITAN GRAND LODGE/CHAPTER MENTORING TEAM

Metropolitan Grand Lodge/Chapter has established a team for coordinating and supporting Mentors throughout London. The team is led by the Metropolitan Grand Mentor, who has a Deputy and seven Assistant Metropolitan Grand Mentors (AMMs) reporting to him. Six of these AMMs have five Mentoring Liaison Officers (MLOs) reporting to them and the seventh looks after Special Projects.

a. Assistant to the Metropolitan Grand Mentor

The AMMs assist the Metropolitan Grand Mentor and his Deputy in establishing and sharing 'Best Practice' across the Mentoring Groups with a view to increasing their performance and effectiveness. As such, each AMM maintains regular communication with the MLOs within their Mentoring Group to ensure that issues are dealt with quickly and effectively, so that the MLOs maintain a productive association with their lodge/chapter Mentors, the VOs, and the MetGInsp. Inspectorates will have one or more Metropolitan Assistant Grand Inspectors (MAGI) with responsibility for oversight of Mentoring within the Inspectorate.

b. Mentoring Liaison Officer

MLOs are structured around the Metropolitan Grand Lodge/Chapter Inspectorates, with one MLO allocated to each of the lodges or chapters looked after by a MetGInsp. Each MetGInsp, via his MAGI therefore has an MLO who he can call upon as a mentoring resource.

It is the MLO's role to function as an information conduit between his nominated AMM and the lodge/chapter Mentors within his designated allocation of approximately fifty lodges or chapters. This in turn enables the lodge/chapter Mentors to provide the highest standards of service and support to brethren or companions who have been selected as personal mentors providing a one-to-one relationship with new Masons and with brethren or companions at all stages in their Masonic journey. They will also assist in co-ordinating activates such as the Welcome Project within their assigned Inspectorate.

c. The MLO, The VO and the MetGInsp

As from late 2023, the Inspectorate management structure changed, and the VOs now report directly to the MetGInsp. There are also a number of Met. Asst. Grand Inspectors (MAGI) who are responsible to the MetGInsp for various aspects of the management of the Inspectorate. The management structure is shown below:

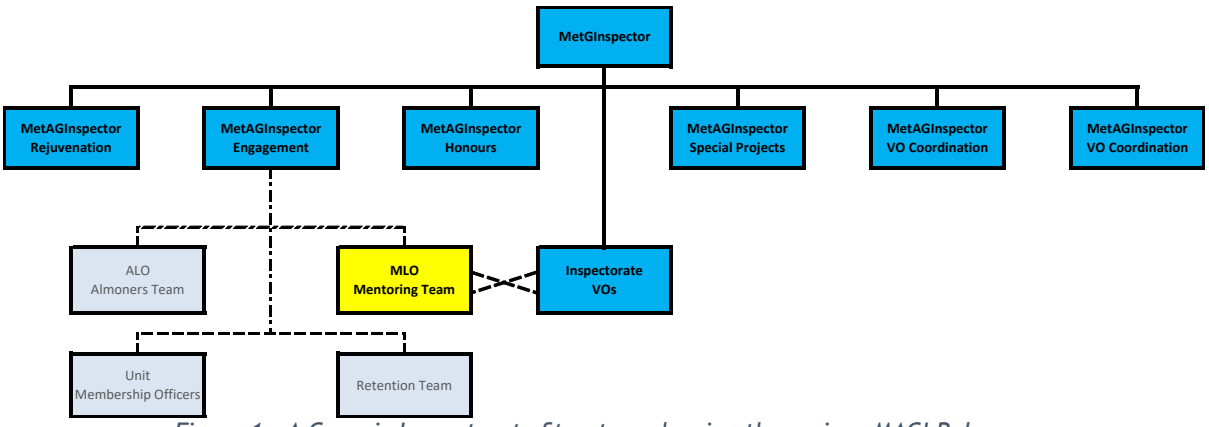


Figure 1 - A Generic Inspectorate Structure showing the various MAGI Roles

Within this structure, the MAGI: Engagement needs to interact with various existing teams within the MetGL/MetGC organisation including:

- Unit Membership Officers - Shape & Attract
- Mentoring Team - Engage & Continue
- Almoner's Team - Respond
- Retention Team - Respond

As each MLO is allocated to one Inspectorate, the MetGInsp has one MLO who he can call upon as a mentoring resource. The MLO will therefore collaborate closely with the MAGI: Engagement and the VOs of his allocated Inspectorate to ensure that Mentoring is effectively promoted. Mentoring within the Inspectorate Units will be monitored by the VO; progress will be reported by the VO immediately after their visit and forwarded to the MLO as soon as possible thereafter.

d. The Lodge Mentor or Chapter Mentoring Coordinator

The lodge Mentor or chapter Mentoring Coordinator (hereafter called the lodge/chapter Mentor) should be an experienced Mason and be the person who ensures that structured mentoring takes place within the lodge or chapter. He is the "organiser" and is not necessarily required to function as a personal mentor. The lodge/chapter Mentor is responsible for coordinating and selecting suitable brethren to be the personal mentors. It is most certainly not the intention that the lodge/chapter Mentor should conduct the task himself. The role of the lodge/chapter Mentor is therefore to organise and coordinate the mentoring of everyone in the lodge or chapter, no matter how junior or senior, no matter how young or old. This officer is also responsible for promoting learning and development within the lodge/chapter, especially the use of Solomon.

e. The Personal Mentor

The personal mentor is a suitably experienced and appropriate person who is assigned to a brother or companion as his personal mentor. As a personal mentor, he is responsible for the day-to-day, one-on-one personal mentoring of his charge(s). The most important part of his role as the candidate's personal mentor is to be a friend and guide to him. He helps the candidate to become involved in the lodge/chapter and to understand and enjoy his Freemasonry.

f. Mentoring Skill Set

The skills required of the personal mentor are many. But may be summarised as follows:

- Be a good listener.
- Can inspire the learner.
- Can suspend judgement and prejudice.
- Be able to give constructive feedback without being patronising.
- Know how and where to get information or skills he does not have.
- Understand that each relationship is unique.

3 BUILDING TOGETHER FOR MENTORS - GUIDANCE AND SUPPORT

The aim of Mentoring Team is to provide advice, guidance, and support to the candidate via the lodge/chapter Mentor and the personal mentor. The following points outline some of the topics that need to be considered at the various stages of the candidate's Masonic journey.

a. UGLE Building Together

Building Together, illustrated below, is a hub which is divided into themes, elements, and responsibilities. The themes are SHAPE, ATTRACT, CONTINUE, ENGAGE and RESPOND.



Building Together has been developed to provide an overall framework to help Lodges to:

- **SHAPE** Lodge and Membership Development.
- **ATTRACT** and welcome new members.
- **CONTINUE** covers Royal Arch attraction up to the point of exaltation.
- **ENGAGE** with new and existing members to reduce losses through resignations, cessations, and exclusions.
- **RESPOND** Find ways to encourage those who have drifted away to re-kindle their interest and re-join.

The aim is to help all lodges become vibrant in which every meeting, including dining, is so enjoyable and worthwhile every member looks forward to the next meeting with an enthusiasm that is infectious.

Building Together is described in detail along with other useful information here: https://b.ugle.org.uk/membership

Mentoring is responsible for the ENGAGE theme of Building Together. The Mentoring Team is aligned with and oriented towards the ENGAGE theme, but it is also involved in the CONTINUE and RETREIVE themes.

b. Recruitment

Recruitment is the direct responsibility of the unit's Membership Officer. However, it is important that the Mentor participates in this early stage. It cannot be stressed too much that the way in which a candidate is recruited is the first step in ensuring that he will remain a productive member of the lodge/chapter for many years. While there is a tendency to tell the candidate as little as possible before his Initiation, this does not allow the candidate to examine his reasons for becoming a mason or to make an informed decision that he will be happy to stand by.

1. Candidate Selection and Assessment

Before a formal interview is arranged, it is good practice for members of the lodge to get to know the candidate during informal social occasions. Thus, when the interview takes place, not only is the candidate already amongst friends and therefore hopefully more relaxed, but he and his character will already be known to those members of the lodge conducting the interview.

It is worth including in the Formal Interview team the brother whose on-going responsibility will be to function as a friend and

guide or personal mentor to the new member, to show him the ropes and to ensure that his questions are answered.

2. The Interview

   Examples of the points which should be covered by the interview team include:

   - What are his motives for wanting to become a Freemason?
   - Are his moral and mental standards satisfactory?
   - Having advised him of the subscription and other costs, will his acceptance create any financial or domestic problems? Advise him of the potential call on him for charitable contributions.
   - Will he have the support of his partner in his decision to become a Freemason? Such support will be essential if he is to enjoy a full participation in his lodge.
   - Explain the procedure and reasons for balloting for new members and why he needs to be interviewed.
   - Explain the start times, dates and frequency of the meetings and general format of them. It is worth mentioning the need to attend Lodge of Instruction meetings in addition to the regular meetings of the lodge.
   - Inform him of the additional time commitment expected if he takes office in the lodge and the advantage of visiting other lodges in the coming years.
   - Advise him of the social activities of the lodge.

   It should already have been established that he has a belief in a Supreme Being and copies of the explanatory booklets explaining Freemasonry should also have been provided to him previously.

3. After the Ballot

   Following his election and if time permits, the lodge Secretary should write a congratulatory letter to the candidate, which will tell him of the proposed date of his initiation and confirm the fees he will be expected to pay on the night. He should also be told of the correct dress for the evening.

   During the intervening period whilst waiting for the meeting at which the initiation will take place, the lodge Mentor should be working with his personal mentor in the background to ensure that all matters pertaining to his initiation have been covered and not assume that someone else has dealt with them.

4. The Lead Up to Initiation

   Before the initiation of the candidate, the lodge Mentor should:

   - Meet the candidate socially as many times as possible with other lodge members (especially the JD), ideally in a relaxed social environment.
   - Assign him a suitable and appropriate personal mentor.
   - Involve the candidate's partner where possible in lodge social functions.
   - Give the candidate pertinent information and facts about Freemasonry.
   - Fully explain the financial and time commitments.
   - Encourage and answer questions and dispel myths and legends!
   - Ensure the candidate is fully prepared for the ceremony, aware of what he will be asked to do and why, what he must wear and what he must bring with him.
   - Be open and honest and do not let him have any unpleasant surprises!
   - Contact him the day before or on the day of his initiation.

   This should ensure that the candidate arrives at his initiation as prepared as he can be. Immediately before the Ceremony, it is good practice for the Proposer, or personal mentor, to introduce the Candidate to the Tyler and the Junior Deacon, who can both reassure him and make sure that he does not feel isolated.

5. Role of the Tyler

   Whilst not directly connected with the Mentoring Programme, a note of the importance of the Tyler's role is appropriate. The Candidate relies heavily on the Tyler whilst he is outside the door of the lodge, and it is most important that the Tyler is aware of the significance of his role in the proceedings - such as:

   Before the Ceremony:

   - Ensure the Candidate is properly prepared.
   - Reassure him. Remind him that all Freemasons are prepared and initiated in the same manner and give him confidence.

   After the Ceremony:

- Check that the Candidate knows how to give the appropriate sign(s) correctly according to the custom and ritual of the lodge.
- Make sure he is fully ready before being re-admitted to the lodge.

c. The Initiate

As we may all dimly recall, the role of Brother Initiate can be very lonely. There are lots of strange sights, strange language, and strange people. As Mentors we must dispel this strangeness as soon as possible after the Initiation Ceremony is completed.

Ideally, the personal mentor should be positioned so that he is sitting next to the candidate once the candidate has been seated. From this position, the personal mentor can explain what is going on and more importantly how the candidate needs to react.

1. The WELCOME PROJECT

The overarching objective of the Welcome Project is to ensure that every Initiate and Exaltee in a Metropolitan Grand lodge/chapter will have an early opportunity to attend and observe a high-quality Initiation/Exaltation at a Welcome Project meeting soon after joining.

The aims are:

- To welcome new initiates and exaltees and highlight a good ceremony soon after their own.
- To allow direct access to a Met Ruler and the answering of early queries.
- To enable bonding between peer groups across lodges and chapters.
- To support the engagement activities already undertaken in Welcome Seminars.
- To increase the level of active participation of new members in other Lodges/Chapters

This project sits squarely within the ENGAGE element of the Members' Pathway supporting new recent initiates and exaltees in participation in a special event, developing understanding, active bonding, and involvement.

The way in which the Welcome Project works is as follows: Several Lodges/Chapters across the Metropolitan area will host Welcome Project meetings throughout the Masonic year to which recent initiates and exaltees will be invited to attend.

The VO will at, or soon after, the Initiation/Exaltation ceremony assist them to select a convenient meeting and book attendance via the dedicated Welcome Project website. It is hoped that the personal mentor will attend with the Initiate/Exaltee. The Welcome Project coordinators will send an e-mail to all initiates/exaltees after the Inspector or AMet (RA) has sent his welcome letter inviting them to book a meeting. The letter will be a personal invitation from their AMet to visit the website and book into a meeting; the VO is copied into the correspondence.

It is also planned to hold "Showcase" Meetings in both Craft and Royal Arch, in the Craft these will be Met Grand Steward's hosted meetings with a narrated initiation, and in Royal Arch the Stewards will present "Added Theatre", three of each are planned in any one masonic year.

2. The Personal Mentoring Plan

The personal mentor should ensure that each new member enjoys his masonry, makes new friends, and is encouraged to make a daily advancement in masonic knowledge. It is the role of the personal mentor, assisted by other knowledgeable members of the lodge, to facilitate this aim by providing each member with the level of support, training and education that best suits his needs and aspirations. The Metropolitan Mentoring Team offers workshops and webinars to train the would-be mentor in his key role. But more support may well be needed in performing the day-to-day activities of mentoring the members of his lodge in accordance with Building Together. To this end, the Metropolitan Mentoring Team has produced a Personal Mentoring Guide and accompanying Personal Mentoring Plan to help Mentors support, develop and educate the members of their lodge. Both documents are available for download from the Mentor section of Rosetta (https://www.rosetta.london/mentor/mentoring-resources).

The Personal Mentoring Plan is closely aligned with Building Together and is aimed primarily at the ENGAGE elements of the Pathway. As such it provides detailed information about the mentee and his journey within masonry. The Plan can therefore be of help when undertaking the RESPOND elements as a source of relevant information about the member.

The Personal Mentoring Plan can be adapted and personalised for each member and will allow the mentor to track and direct the member's development. It is also recommended that the mentee hold a copy of his Personal Mentoring Plan so that he is aware of what is to come and those areas where he may need

additional mentoring. The Plan has a useful summary section where the mentor or mentee can record key events on the mentee's masonic journey. The remainder of the document is broken down into seven key stages which relate to logical masonic milestones as discussed at the Metropolitan Mentoring Workshops and Webinars and detailed in the Building Together brochure.

Each key stage is presented in the form of a Development Guidance List which is cross referenced to further documentation where appropriate to provide additional explanation and information for the mentor. These lists are meant only for guidance and should be tailored as the mentor sees fit; you should be ready to adapt the framework to the needs of your lodge and its members; when you come across something that works then don't be afraid to repeat it. Do not use the plan as a means of forcing the mentee to do things. He should always be made to feel comfortable with the activities detailed on the plan which should be regularly reviewed with the Lodge/personal mentor.

The Personal Mentoring Guide is there to assist the mentor in providing development and education to masons at all stages of their masonic journey. This guide is not intended to be prescriptive and may be adapted by the mentor to suit the needs of his lodge and the aspirations of each member; every lodge is different, and every member has diverse needs. Some of the key early steps are set out in the following paragraphs.

3. Activities after Initiation

Specific activities that need to be undertaken by the personal mentor after the candidate is initiated are as follows.

In the short term:

- Ensure that the candidate has all the available information and literature including the Initiates Guide – the lodge Mentor should ensure that the Secretary has a copy well before the Initiation Meeting.
- Conduct a review of the ceremony with him.
- Ensure that he understands the reasons for what happened.
- Encourage him to ask questions and provide answers.
- Provide him with the MetGL Hymn Card for the Closing Ode.
- In the longer term:

- Arrange a visit to another Initiation Ceremony as soon as possible.
- Advise him on techniques for memorising the ritual.
- Fully prepare him for his Second Degree.
- Keep in frequent touch with him.
- If the next meeting is in a higher Degree, ensure that he is accompanied from the lodge by his personal mentor or other suitable brother.
- Use this absence from the lodge to give him some structured Masonic education.

4. First Get Together After Initiation

This meeting between the personal mentor and the new member should take place following initiation and prior to the next lodge meeting. The new member may be loaned, or given, a copy of the ritual of the ceremony he has just undergone and be encouraged to read it through with his personal mentor. This will enable him to raise any questions as to the ceremony itself. He should also be given a copy of the "test questions" in preparation for his next Degree ceremony.

Following his initiation, the new brother should have been given a copy of the Initiate's Guide. The personal mentor should take the opportunity to review this with him to ascertain whether it raises any questions upon which the brother might require further guidance.

5. Subjects for Discussion

As soon as practical after the Ceremony of Initiation, the personal mentor should cover the following topics with his charge:

- The Ceremony of Initiation, its form and significance.
- The Obligation, Entrusting and the Apron.
- The teachings of the Degree, particularly charity and benevolence within Freemasonry.
- The Signs, Token and Word and the method of giving the Sign in accordance with the ritual and customs of the lodge.
- Explain the Sign of Reverence (i.e. thumb hidden) and its use during Prayers.

6. The Organisation of the Lodge

The personal mentor should cover the following topics regarding the organisation of the lodge:

- Brief description of the way the seating is arranged in the lodge, showing the location of the principal officers.
- Explain the function of various officers of the lodge during meetings and otherwise, e.g. the Almoner's pastoral duties; the Secretary's duties as well as those of the Director of Ceremonies, Treasurer, Charity Steward, etc.
- How to recognise officers by their collar jewels.
- The structure of Freemasonry under the English Constitution.

7. Masonic Etiquette and Protocol

The Mentor should discuss the following topics of Masonic etiquette and protocol with the candidate.

What may be discussed under the various Risings:

- First Rising: communications from Grand Lodge/Chapter.
- Second Rising: communications from Metropolitan or Grand Lodge/Chapter and certain propositions.
- Third Rising: other communications in general, other propositions, letters, and information for the benefit of the brethren and in some cases, greetings from visiting brethren.

The procedure for conducting Ballots within the lodge:

- By show of hands.
- By ballot slips.
- By ballot box.

Instruct the new member on the circumstances when they are used and what he should do in each event when asked to vote.

8. Charity

Now is also a suitable time to introduce the new member to some of the charitable work done by Freemasons in and for the outside community. It is important to explain the many ways in which the new member can make contributions to the lodge's charities.

9. Festive Board

The first Festive Board attended by a new member can be a daunting experience. Not only is he seated at the top table at

the right of the WM, but he is also expected to make a speech. Some advice and guidance are therefore appropriate:

- How to conduct Masonic Fire properly and its origins – it is not amusing to let the candidate struggle with this – instruction should therefore be given before the Festive Board.
- What toasts are given and the order in which they are honoured.
- How to address the members of the lodge at the start of a speech and what should and should not be included or said in a speech – the lodge Mentor should ensure the Initiate receives a draft speech prior to his Initiation that he can tailor to suit what he would like to say.

d. Subsequent Degrees and Beyond

The personal mentoring Plan continues to provide essential mentoring guidance well beyond the First Degree and should continue to be applied as summarised in the following paragraphs.
Specific activities that need to be undertaken prior to the candidate taking subsequent degrees are as follows:

- Prepare the candidate for the next step in his Masonic career.
- Rehearse him in his actions for the Opening & Closing Ceremony in each Degree.
- Ensure that he has learnt the answers to the questions leading to the next Degree.
- Contact him the day before or on the day of his ceremonies to make sure that he is all right and does not have any questions.
- Ensure that his personal mentor rehearses him in the test questions and answers.
- Make sure that the JD or SD meet him before the ceremonies.

After each Degree, the following activities should be undertaken:

- Conduct a review of the ceremony with him.
- Ensure that he understands the reasons for what happened.
- Continue to encourage and answer questions.
- Arrange a visit to witness the Degree he has completed as soon as possible.
- Fully prepare him for his next Degree.
- Keep in frequent touch with him.
- If the next meeting in in a higher Degree, ensure that he is accompanied from the lodge by his personal mentor or other suitable brother.

- Use this absence from the lodge to give him some structured Masonic education.

1. After Passing

After his Passing, it should be explained that in this Degree he was not hoodwinked because he was already a Freemason and a member of the lodge, a point that he had proved by answering the test questions correctly. Other salient points can be discussed including the derivation of the various words used and what we mean by the "Liberal Arts and Sciences" and how they can be applied in our everyday lives, in the modern world. Ensure he receives a copy of the Fellow Craft's Guide.

Other subjects for discussion include:

- The correct method of giving the Sign, Token and Word of a Fellow Craft Freemason, according to the lodge ritual and custom. It may be appropriate to mention that in some lodges the signs may be given in a slightly different manner.
- The various aprons with which he is, or will be invested, after each Degree. It would be appropriate to ensure that he will have a Master Mason's apron available for when he is to be Raised.
- Aprons of an Installed Master, Provincial Officers and Grand Officers and their respective emblems of rank and collar jewels. Explain the difference between "office" and "rank."
- Further information on Masonic Charities, Metropolitan Grand Lodge charities, the Master's List (if there is one) and guidance as to how he can contribute.

Having heard how the candidate answered the questions before Passing, the personal mentor will be better able to judge how much extra help, if any, may be needed. It is important that the candidate continues to receive help in learning and understanding the answers so that he feels confident during the ceremony. The Mentor may also need to ask the original sponsors to assist the new brother with his learning.

2. After Raising

Subjects for discussion after Raising may include:

- The essence of the Degree. Since the main teaching of the Degree is the preparation for the closing hour of our existence, it may at first seem a macabre subject. In

fact, it is the way in which we conduct ourselves through life that is the key point to be realised and emphasised.

- The correct method of giving the grip of a Master Mason, the communication of the Five Points of Fellowship as taught and practised in the lodge. The correct pronunciation of the words of a Master Mason and their meaning as explained in the ceremony.
- How to sign in properly when visiting another lodge. Explain the caution required when visiting lodges under a different constitution.
- Explain that there are different workings and some lodges may appear to do things very differently from what he has been taught.
- Explain the correct sign to give during the Obligation; w one given in his Mother Lodge, which may be different to the one given in the lodge being visited. For example, some lodges hold the sign of the Degree and some the Sign of Fidelity (whilst lodges of other constitutions in amity, may give a Due Guard Sign).
- Never to pass critical comment on how a working is done in another lodge.
- The etiquette of responding to the Visitors' Toast with emphasis on not telling crude stories or stories critical of another brother. It is worth remembering that the use of "funny" stories should be reserved for those occasions when a particular lesson may be taught by the story.
- Always to thank his host promptly for the invitation to the evening, preferably in writing.
- Check that he knows the structure of Grand Lodge, Metropolitan Grand Lodge, and the identity of the principal Rulers of each.

Specific activities that need to be undertaken after the candidate has taken the Third Degree are as follows:

- Ensure he receives a copy of the Master Mason's Guide.
- Ensure that he understands about Masonic etiquette.
- Explain about taking office in the lodge.
- Encourage regular visiting of other lodges.
- Encourage attendance at Metropolitan Grand Lodge.
- Explain eligibility to attend Grand Lodge.
- Explain the Masonic honours system.
- Encourage regular participation in ceremonies and ritual according to his ability and his wish to do so.

3. After Presentation of the Grand Lodge Certificate

Subjects for discussion may include:

- Make sure that he receives his Grand Lodge certificate in a timely manner and that he understands its purpose, use and symbology.
- The Grand Lodge Certificate. Remind him that it is a form of Masonic Passport and that it should not be framed or displayed but kept with his regalia in case proof of membership is required.
- Attendance at Lodge of Instruction meetings will assist in his understanding of the ritual. He should be encouraged to start learning as soon as possible to be ready to accept office. His Mentor should guide him on which parts should be learned first. Ensure that he now has an up-to-date copy of the lodge ritual.
- Progress to the Master's Chair: explain how the Master appoints his officers and the meaning of "progressive" office. He should be encouraged to consider, and prepare himself for, progressing through the offices. Every effort should be made not to present this as a daunting task.
- A further explanation of each of the offices and the roles they must play during the period of their appointment.
- Review what has been discussed in previous meetings and expand where necessary.
- The Royal Arch as the completion of his Craft Masonic journey.

4. Lodge of Instruction & Taking Office

These are quite often referred to as "rehearsals" and whilst an element of rehearsal and practice takes place, the primary reason is to provide attendees, including those in office or about to take office, with an explanation of various parts of the ritual. Too much care cannot be taken to ensure that each attendee understands the "why" as well as the "how." Other points worth noting at Instruction meetings:

- Get newer brethren to occupy different offices so they get a feel for them.
- Give newer brethren the opportunity of practising those parts they have been learning.
- Consider rehearsing the formal parts of the dinner or Festive Board.
- An established brother might discuss with the newer brethren how to "train the memory" to learn the ritual. The key to this is in understanding its meaning and the lesson it seeks to convey.

- It might be worth seeking the views of the newer brethren on how the meetings might be enhanced and what subjects, if any, might be developed or discussed at the regular meeting when no Degree work is scheduled.

A lodge or chapter with an active Lodge of Instruction (LOI) or Chapter of Instruction (COI), if properly conducted, is the perfect environment at which active mentoring techniques can be applied to great effect.

e. Mentoring the Past Master/First Principal

It is very well known that the period after a member vacates the Chair can be a great let down where he can begin to feel unwanted. The key, as with much of mentoring, is to reinforce the "three Is" - The Past Master/First Principal should remain Included, Involved, and Interested if he is to remain In the lodge.

A brother who has served as Worshipful Master and as IPM or First Principal/Past First Principal ought to be an experienced member of the unit but, all too often these days, this is not always the case. Although some of the items mentioned below may have been discussed with him previously, this discussion may have been a few years ago and are again worth reiterating.

1. Taking Office

The ideal way of maintaining interest is for him to take some office within the unit. The variety of offices available cover a broad range of skills and interests. A ritualist can be guided towards the ADC or DC roles or a position in the LoI/CoI if they have one. Others can function as (Assistant) Secretary or Treasurer, whilst those with people skills may be suited as Almoners or Charity Stewards.

Mentoring is another role that should not be overlooked. Remember that the lodge/chapter Mentor should be coordinating the mentoring so that each candidate has the most suitable personal Mentor allocated to them. This vital role of personal mentor can often be adopted by a recent Past Master and if conducted with thought and enthusiasm, can be extremely rewarding to the personal mentor.

Where circumstances do not allow an individual to take office, he can remain involved by assisting the appointed officers. Positions such as that of Almoner can carry a particular burden, especially in terms of time, and assistance by an enthusiastic Past Master would invariably be gratefully received.

Even if an office is not immediately available there is nothing to stop brethren attending the various workshops, Mentor, Almoner, DC, etc., to develop their knowledge and be of more use to the current holders of those offices. This not only better qualifies them to be of use but makes them obvious candidates as a lodge undertakes succession planning.

There are other roles which, whilst not official offices, may interest some brethren. These include lodge historian, dining secretary and festival secretary.

There is nothing wrong with a Past Master sitting back and enjoying the ceremonies from the back benches, but care must be taken to ensure that he is not neglected. If he is becoming restless or dissatisfied, or starts missing meetings, get him involved again. There is plenty of work to share around, including the Charges, Tracing Boards, Addresses, and other parts of the ceremonies. Why not give him a piece of ritual to make his own "party piece"? How about pieces of ritual not in the ritual book, such as the Mode of Preparation, the Presentation of the White Gloves, Ecclesiastes verse 12 or the Walking Charge?

2. Involvement Outside the Lodge

A Past Master will normally have visited a number of lodges and be aware of Freemasonry beyond his own unit. He will, hopefully, be aware of the existence of Installed Masters' lodges, but may not be aware of the role they play in developing Masonic experience, fellowship and understanding beyond the Degree-oriented practice of an ordinary private lodge.

Similarly, if he is not already a member, he should be aware of the Royal Arch and hopefully of its importance in Pure and Ancient Freemasonry. If the Past Master is not already involved in other orders, and he is so minded, you may wish to discuss the existence of these with him.

Involvement in Freemasonry is not only limited to work in the lodge or lodges. There are also a number of other Masonic bodies, which may be of interest and maintain the Past Master's involvement. These include research lodges or circles, such as QCCC (Quatuor Coronati Lodge), special interest Lodges, the Masonic Study Circle, and others. Then there are ritual associations such as the Emulation Lodge of Improvement, which meets weekly. A number of charities such as Teddies for Loving Care, the Masonic Trout and Salmon Fishing Charity or

simply the Masonic Sporting Associations for bowling, clay shooting or rambling all provide further opportunities for involvement. Finally, Metropolitan Grand Lodge is always looking for intelligent and enthusiastic volunteers to help with a variety of projects.

3. Honours

The question of honours is a subject that is often controversial and hotly debated and is an area in which there is much misunderstanding. It is obvious, that discussions on this subject should be managed carefully, and if there is any doubt as to the accuracy of your information, then advice should be sought from your unit's VO.

Honours in London are awarded strictly on a merit basis and are bestowed in recognition of service to London Freemasonry. They are most definitely not awarded merely on a time-served basis.

The Past Master should be encouraged to do the things he enjoys and does well. This will keep him actively involved and increase his chances of receiving recognition.

For those brethren who already hold LGR, the question of SLGR may be an even more difficult one to tackle. Whilst LGR largely recognises efforts within the lodge, SLGR is awarded to those who have actively and continuously demonstrated a wider support for London Freemasonry, including an active membership of the Royal Arch, a willingness to become further involved in London Masonry, such as becoming a VO, and an active involvement in the wider, non-Masonic community.

Honours should not be assumed to be a given right; however, an understanding of the system and its application can be a useful tool for the Mentor when working out how best to keep a Past Master involved. Finally, it should be remembered that the lodge VO has input into the nomination process and obvious "apron chasing" may be noted to the Past Master's detriment.

f. Mentoring in the Royal Arch

Some believe that mentoring in the Royal Arch is not needed; after all, only experienced Masons join! However, this is simply not the case. A Master Mason of 4 weeks can join the Royal Arch and, even to the experienced Mason, the Royal Arch can seem confusing and its ritual esoteric and daunting. Imagine what it can be like to someone new to it. In addition, we have already seen that experienced Masons need

mentoring, and this is also the case in the Royal Arch, up to and beyond the Chairs.

It is also vital that the meanings of the Royal Arch are explained so that a new Companion can understand the significance of the ceremony and enjoy the Order.

As you may expect, many aspects of mentoring in the Royal Arch and the available tools are the same as those in the Craft.

1. **CONTINUE**

   The **CONTINUE** hub is designed for Royal Arch Chapters to help shape their future, grow their membership, and enhance their member's experience. It is based on extensive research of what our members want—and what works well in successful, thriving Chapters across our Constitution.

   Many of the challenges that chapters face are different to lodges. **CONTINUE** is therefore not a simple translation of Archway and so has been developed separately. However, some of the challenges are similar.

   CONTINUE aims to help Chapters become more vibrant and more enjoyable, so that every Companion looks forward to their next meeting with enthusiasm. Resources to enhance understanding of the Royal Arch are also provided along with advice for attracting new members, and for supporting every member of the Chapter.

   It is intended to be an evolving resource with more examples and case studies of good practice added over time. There is no one size fits all solution, but the resources and options it offers highlight what is possible to achieve if Chapters wish to embrace change and secure their future.

   We encourage you to head to the **CONTINUE** hub and try for yourself, you can find this via Rosetta).

2. Before Exaltation

   Ideally a lodge Mentor should introduce a brother to a Royal Arch Mentor, and both work together to the benefit of the brother, as he becomes a Companion!

   It is important that they:

   - Ensure that he fully understands what he is joining.

- Give him all pertinent information and facts.
- Fully explain the financial and time commitments.
- Encourage him to ask questions and then answer questions; be open and honest with him.
- Ensure he is fully prepared for the ceremony, aware of what he will be asked to do and why, what he must wear & what he must bring with him.
- Make sure that he has the full regalia.
- Contact him the day before or on the day of his Exaltation.
- Introduce him to the Principal Sojourner before the ceremony.
- Rehearse him in the signs in the three Degrees and words of a Master Mason on the Five Points of Fellowship.

As with the Tyler in Craft, a note of the importance of the Janitor's role is appropriate. The Candidate relies heavily on the Janitor whilst he is outside the door of the chapter to:

Before the Ceremony:

- Ensure the Candidate is properly prepared.
- Remind him of the signs in the three Degrees and words of a Master Mason on the Five Points of Fellowship.

After the Ceremony:

- Check that the Candidate knows how to give the appropriate sign(s) correctly.
- Make sure he is fully ready before being re-admitted to the chapter.

3. After Exaltation

After Exaltation, the following topics should be addressed as soon as practicable:

- Ensure that he has all the available information and literature, especially the Exaltee's Guide.
- Conduct a review of the ceremony with him.
- Explain the meanings behind the ceremony and the lectures.
- Encourage him to ask questions.
- Arrange a visit to another Exaltation as soon as possible.
- Make sure that he receives his Supreme Grand Chapter certificate in a timely manner and that he understands its purpose, use and symbology.

- Explain about taking office and progression in the RA.
- Encourage attendance at Metropolitan Grand Chapter.
- Encourage attendance at Supreme Grand Chapter.
- Explain the Royal Arch honours system.
- Mentor him as necessary up to and beyond the Chairs.

4. Dinner or Festive Board

Again, whilst he will be familiar with Dinners and Festive Boards, it is again appropriate to provide advice on:

- How to conduct Royal Arch Fire properly and its origins.
- What toasts are given and the order in which they are honoured.
- How to address the members of the chapter at the start of a speech.

5. The Welcome Project

The overarching objective of the Welcome Project is to ensure that every Initiate and Exaltee in a Metropolitan Grand Lodge/Chapter will have an early opportunity to attend and observe a high-quality Initiation/Exaltation at a Welcome Project meeting soon after joining.

The aims are:

- To welcome new initiates and exaltees and highlight a good ceremony soon after their own.
- To allow direct access to a Met Ruler and the answering of early queries.
- To enable bonding between peer groups across lodges and chapters.
- To support the engagement activities already undertaken in Welcome Seminars.
- To increase the level of active participation of new members in other lodges/chapters

This project sits squarely within the ENGAGE element of the Building Together supporting new recent initiates and exaltees in participation in a special event, developing understanding, active bonding, and involvement.

The way in which the Welcome Project works is as follows: A number of lodges/chapters across the Metropolitan area will host Welcome Project meetings throughout the Masonic year to which recent initiates and exaltees will be invited to attend. The VO will at, or soon after, the Initiation/Exaltation ceremony

assist them to select a convenient meeting and book attendance via the dedicated Welcome Project website. It is hoped that the personal mentor will attend with the Initiate/Exaltee. The Welcome Project coordinators will send an e-mail to all initiates/exaltees after the Inspector or AMet (RA) has sent his welcome letter inviting them to book a meeting. The letter will be a personal invitation from their AMet to visit the website and book into a meeting; the VO is copied into the correspondence.

It is also planned to hold "Showcase" Meetings in both Craft and Royal Arch, in the Craft these will be Met Grand Steward's hosted meetings with a narrated initiation, and in Royal Arch the Stewards will present "Added Theatre", three of each are planned in any one masonic year.

6. Taking Office

Try to encourage the new Companion to a regular participation in ceremonies and ritual according to his ability and his wish to do so. This is particularly important in the Holy Royal Arch as the role of Principal Sojourner can appear very daunting and can occur very quickly after a Companion is exalted. It is becoming accepted that this may now be split up, if necessary, to make it less of a challenge.

The fact that the path to the Third Principals Chair is so short means that Mentoring needs to be taken very seriously.

4 TUITION AND EDUCATION

Previously we have spoken about the importance of Advice, Guidance and Support in the Mentoring process. However, this can only be offered if the brethren asked to perform the Mentoring role have the knowledge to perform the job properly. Likewise, there will be instances where the information required of the Mentor is just too great or complex for him to manage. It is in these cases where the MetGL Mentoring Team will provide the required Tuition and Education to satisfy these demands.

a. Mentoring Webinars

It has been shown that Webinars provide an effective way of communicating facts and techniques across a full range of Masonic activities. The MetGL Mentoring Team has therefore developed Mentoring Webinars tailored to meet the needs of the Mentor.

b. Lodge/Chapter and Personal Mentors Webinars

Since the launch of the London Mentoring training programme in September 2008, the Mentoring Team have been running Mentoring Webinars and Mentoring Workshops at Freemasons' Hall for the benefit of appointed Mentors and those seeking to gain knowledge of Mentoring. Since the Covid Lockdown, the Workshops have given way to Webinars which have proved to be extremely popular.

At these Webinars, the Metropolitan Grand Mentor with the Mentoring Team, provide the resources and training for every London Lodge to appoint a lodge Mentor and every London Chapter to appoint a Chapter Mentoring Coordinator to oversee and ensure that Mentoring is successful in every London Masonic unit.

1. Mentoring Liaison Officers' Webinars

The MLO plays a key role being the interface between the MetGL Mentoring Team, the MetGInsp and the Lodges/Chapters assigned to him. The MLO is also required to assist with the presentation of the various Webinars operated by the MetGL Mentoring Team. It is therefore essential that the MLO is provided with the knowledge, skills, and best practice to be able to perform his role properly and effectively.

The MLO Webinar has therefore been devised to bring prospective MLO's up to speed within the role that they aspire to perform. It is expected that the Webinar will be run once a year prior to the start of the new Masonic season.

2. Mentoring Best Practice Webinars

The MetGL Mentoring Team have a policy of continuous process improvement and are always looking for and assessing Best Practice. Webinars will therefore be arranged on an as required basis to instruct incumbent Mentors in those techniques deemed to be Best Practice for Mentoring in London Lodges and Chapters.

3. Degree Ceremony Demonstrations

Degree Ceremony Demonstrations during a candidate's progression through each Degree ceremony, there is a requirement that the Mentor will arrange for the candidate to see that ceremony as soon as possible afterwards. The MetGL Mentoring Team will arrange for demonstrations of the ceremonies to be performed by selected Lodges and Ritual Demonstration Teams as appropriate to meet this need.
Only those of the appropriate rank will be permitted to attend these demonstrations and the MLO/VO will be expected to confirm each attendee is qualified before a booking is made.

The intention is that a candidate will have the opportunity to see a good quality ceremony, with additional explanations and narration.

1. Initiation

   The Initiation ceremony can be very confusing for the candidate, and they may well not be able to remember a lot of the details. It is therefore recommended that their personal Mentor or another experienced Brother accompanies them when they attend a demonstration or ceremony to provide further explanation and answer questions. The Welcome Project arrange demonstrations throughout the year, and all Initiate's should receive an invitation. Additional ritual such as the First-Degree Tracing May be included.

2. Passing, Raising, Installation and Exaltation

   Similar demonstrations are available for these ceremonies and again a candidate should have the opportunity to either attend a demonstration or the ceremony shortly after they have been through it. The candidate will almost certainly have questions and be unclear on aspect of the ceremony and this is especially true for the Royal Arch. The support of an experienced Brother/Companion is again recommended.

c. Office Holder Mentoring Workshops

1. Past MetGL/MetGC Officers

At present, many outgoing MetGL/MetGC Officers experience a sense of anticlimax after their active year has finished. The objects of this seminar are:

- To give outgoing officers the ability to continue to contribute to and feel a sense of belonging to the Metropolitan family.
- To allow them to discover and make an informed decision about the options available to them to contribute their skills and available time.
- To overcome the feeling of disappointment and anticlimax after coming to the end of a busy and exciting year.
- To allow MetGL/MetGC to identify and recruit motivated people at a time when they are most likely to want to commit.
- To fit volunteers to the roles most closely matched to their skills and wishes. To expand and develop the skill set of future leaders of MetGL/MetGC.

The Next Steps Seminar is normally held in February for those leaving office to understand what other options may be available.

2. Past Masters

Many Past Master experience a sense of anti-climax after they leave the Chair. The objects of this seminar are:

- To give Past Masters the ability to continue to contribute to and feel a sense of belonging to the Lodge.
- To allow them to discover and make an informed decision about the options available to them to contribute their skills and available time to the benefit of the lodge and MetGL.
- To overcome the feeling of disappointment and anticlimax after coming to the end of a busy and exciting period as WM and IPM.
- To allow MetGL/MetGC to identify and recruit motivated people at a time when they are most likely to want to commit.
- To fit volunteers to the roles most closely matched to their skills and wishes.

- To expand and develop their skill set of future leaders of MetGL/MetGC.

3. Worshipful Masters & Wardens

   The progression through the Wardens Chairs to the Masters Chair can be a frightening experience. While the Ritual Book gives an excellent picture of the ritual that must be learned, there are many things that are outside its remit and usually picked up piecemeal.

   The aim of this seminar is to cover the duties of the Wardens and the Worshipful Master that do not appear in the Ritual Book but are none the less essential to a happy and productive year in Office.

5 RETENTION

a. Retention Issues

1. Holding on to Office

It is possible that some brethren may be discouraged by the "non-progressive" offices being held by the same brethren for too long. The recommendation of the Board of General Purposes of Grand Lodge is that no one should hold office for more than five years, seven at the outside. Not only does holding an office for longer discourage others by letting them think there is no opportunity for them to aspire to an office, but it also places the unit at risk when one of these long-standing officers suddenly becomes incapable of performing the duties of his office.

2. Reasons for Leaving

Too often resignations are accepted without question. There is a need for a "cooling off" period during which a member may be visited to discuss his reasons for his decision. Who knows, we may all learn something that might prevent others from taking similar action? It is known for such consideration to reverse a decision to resign and re-kindle a brother's interest in Freemasonry.

Nevertheless, it is true that advancing years are very often the reason for resignation, in such cases it is courteous to respect the wishes of the brother concerned.

All resignations MUST be notified immediately to the Metropolitan Grand Lodge Retention Team.

3. Are we too quick to Exclude?

The bane of the treasurer's life is the continued need to chase brethren for their annual dues. These are always due in advance and are payable on the first day of the new financial year of the lodge's accounts. Use of standing order systems can help with prompt payment but may cause difficulties when the annual subscription changes, as it invariably will, from time to time.

On the other hand, units are under extreme pressure to meet their financial commitments and settle their accounts as they fall due, to keep costs and thereby subscriptions at an acceptable level. For this reason, it may mean that the unit is quick to move to the exclusion process. This matter needs

careful consideration as it is quite likely that we are losing members who might not otherwise be lost if a more pro-active approach were to be adopted to simplify payment of subscriptions.

Whilst a unit may not pay a member's subscriptions directly, nevertheless where extreme hardship prevents a member from meeting his financial obligations to the unit, it may be worth considering imaginative ways to assist this brother in distressed circumstances, rather than lose a member of many years' standing through reasons of hardship.

4. Meeting Start Times

   It is essential that potential candidates are made fully aware of the time they must attend meetings. These include not only the regular meetings of the unit but also meetings of Lodge of Instruction, rehearsal, and committee meetings.

   There may be a good case for varying the times of committee and Lodge of Instruction meetings to fit in with a brother's private or public avocations. There may be a number of acceptable reasons why a brother may not attend at certain times and the brethren ought to be able to accommodate him so that he may take office within his unit. It is, or course, more difficult to change the times of the regular meetings.

   The dates and times of other relevant meetings, such as those of Metropolitan Grand Lodge, should also be communicated to the brethren at an early opportunity. When a brother is appointed a Warden in his lodge, his should, by virtue of his office, attend Metropolitan Grand Lodge, dressed in his collar of office. He is also eligible and should be encouraged to attend the Quarterly Communications of Grand Lodge, similarly attired.

5. Retention of Members

   It is essential for each lodge and all its members to do everything possible to address issues that lead to non-attendance and resignations.

   It is, sadly, common for a Master Mason to leave the Craft on the completion of his Third Degree. Primarily, it is essential that Master Masons enjoy their Freemasonry and are properly encouraged to play an active part in the workings of the lodge by assisting at the Festive Board and attending Lodge of Instruction meetings.

Similarly, the Worshipful brother who, having experienced the "high" of his year in the Chair of his lodge, often experiences the "low" that sometimes follows, and he may, if he is not involved further, drift away.

Missing meetings can be habit forming and all brethren should play their part in making enquiries as to why a member is not attending. Too often is expressed the view that he will come if he wants to. This is seldom true, and sometimes greater encouragement is needed to maintain a brother's attention and attendance.

There are a number of things they can do to assist in the management of the unit. The task of the Almoner should include checking on brethren who are not attending on a regular basis who should be the targets of some form of regular communication, other than simply being sent the lodge summons. Brethren could be assigned to one or more "missing" brother with a view to befriending them and maintaining a personal contact with them. Brethren who are unable to attend the lodge through health reasons would especially appreciate this personal contact. In other cases, such contact has may encourage the return to the lodge of some, whose non-attendance might soon lead to resignation.

The subject of retaining and caring for our brethren is complex and each lodge will need to adapt to the changing circumstances of the world around us and the needs of its members.

b. Retention Process

1. Overview, Process and Key Points for Mentors

A Retention process, incorporating Recovery and Support, has been developed to address membership issues with the aim of understanding the real reason(s) for resignation and aims to assist a brother to withdraw his resignation or seek assistance in joining a new unit if he desires. The result of the contact will be to either assist the brother or offer the gratitude of Metropolitan Grand Lodge for the service he has rendered.

The Retention Team will contact every member who resigns and conduct a sympathetic and completely confidential exit interview. A resignation may well be an emotional event for the brother concerned, and experience has shown that any

avoidable delay will almost certainly render him irretrievable and an unnecessary loss to the Craft.

The Retention initiative has achieved remarkable success - around one in three cases have been resolved with a positive result for Freemasonry and for the member concerned. Brethren have, for example, withdrawn resignations and/or joined another unit.

There will be occasions when the brother concerned feels that he must resign due to age or infirmity, but such cases must not be ignored or classed as inevitable. It may often be that a brother who has not attended his lodge for some time will really appreciate having a friendly call to thank him for his contribution over the years - and, of course, to assure him that the benefits of membership (such as those accessible through the Almoner Service) are still available to him.

If financial difficulties have given rise to the resignation, this needs to be handled extremely delicately, and the Contact Officer will make sure that the brother knows that the door is always open for him to return to active Freemasonry as and when circumstances permit.

Several key issues have been noted by the Retention Team over the last 5 years of operation, namely:

- Many brethren have not attended the unit for several years before the resignation but have not been contacted by any member of the unit to see if there is anything wrong.
- Members have taken offence by the tone of some written communications from the unit in relation to fees owing or non-attendance.
- Some Secretaries/Scribe Es have limited information about members, including home address or telephone numbers.

2. Secretary's/Visiting Officers Responsibilities

A resignation must be notified by the Secretary/Scribe E using the Visiting Officer Exit form and submitted to their respective Visiting Officer, within 72 hours of the receipt of the resignation.

The Form should be downloaded from Rosetta, saved and completed electronically as an Adobe pdf form.

It is the Visiting Officer's responsibility to immediately forward the completed Visiting Officer Exit Form to the Senior Contact Officer shown on the form. It is also the VO's responsibility to ensure as much information as possible has been provided on the form by the Secretary/Scribe E. It is particularly important to include a phone number/e-mail address if available.

3. Mentor's Responsibilities

There are several key areas where the Mentor can be of immense importance in the Retention process both before and after the resignation is received:

- Ensure that the Secretary/Scribe E if aware of the references/timescales and the necessity of completing the form as correctly and completely as possible.
- Ensure that lodge records/membership details are held and accurate.
- Ensure the Secretary/Almoner/Proposer or some other nominated person in the lodge is contacting brethren who are not attending meetings. Non-attendance is often the first sign of dissatisfaction.
- Once a matter of dissatisfaction has been raised, ensure that it is dealt with in an open/honest and caring manner. "Least said – soonest mended" does not tend to work.
- Be aware that some members are facing enormous difficulties in their own lives in either employment, health, or relationships. Some resigning members have found it much easier to talk to someone outside of the lodge about the personal issues they are facing.
- Ensure that key members of the lodge are aware that written communications to brethren can still be "personal and caring" whilst including "bad news" (fees outstanding, etc.)

Further information, assistance and guidance regarding the Retention procedure (before or after resignation) is available from the Retentions Team (Craft & Royal Arch) exitmetgl@hotmail.com.

6 MENTORING RESOURCES

- MetGL/MetGC Mentoring Team metmentor@metmentor.com
- Mentoring Resources http://metmentor.com
- MetGL/MetGC Retention Team retention@metgl.com
- UGLE Masonic Mentoring website: www.masonicmentoring.org.uk
- UGLE Building Together: Rosetta > Building Together
- Solomon – next page – https://solomon.ugle.org.uk
- Rosetta https://www.rosetta.london/
- Book of Constitutions
- Guidance for Members of the Craft
- Metropolitan Grand Lodge/Chapter yearbook
- Initiate's & Exaltee's Guides
- Freemasonry Today
- Arena Magazine
- Grand Lodge Library & Museum
- LGRA – Quarterly Bulletin
- MetGL/MetGC Hymn Card
- Peterborough booklets
- First & Second-Degree Ritual Books
- Masonic Etiquette Today – Graham Redman
- UGLE booklet "Are You Thinking of Becoming a Freemason?"
- UGLE leaflets: "What is Freemasonry?" "Freemasonry and Society" "Freemasonry and Religion" "Freemasonry and Public Affairs" "Freemasonry's External Relations"
- UGLE booklet "What's It All About?"